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*Images of Mahāpratisarā in Bengal:
Their Iconographic Links with Javanese, Central Asian
and East Asian Images*

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IMAGES OF MAHĀPRATISARĀ IN BENGAL : THEIR ICONOGRAPHIC LINKS WITH JAVANESE, CENTRAL ASIAN AND EAST ASIAN IMAGES

Gerd J.R. Mevissen

I. Eastern India

The iconography of the Buddhist goddess Mahāpratisarā is well-attested in the *Sāadhanamālā* (SM) and the *Niṣpannayogāvali* (NSP), where she is described as a multi-headed and eight-armed goddess.¹ Judging from the extant images, the Eastern Indian artists exclusively followed one of these descriptions, namely *sādhana.s* 194-196. Besides several manuscript paintings dating from the 11th to the 13th century,² at least one stone sculpture from Bengal of the 11th century³ follows SM 194-196 and can thus be securely identified as Mahāpratisarā.⁴

However, there are a few images from Eastern India, mostly bronzes from south-east Bengal as well as a stone sculpture from Bihar, that show an eight-armed goddess with only a single head. They have variously been identified as Cundā, Sitātapatrā, Mahāpratyaṅgirā, Mahāpratisarā, Caṇḍī or Durgā. These images may date from the 8th to the 10th century and have certain iconographic features in common. However, no Sanskrit source is known so far that exactly describes this form of an eight-armed goddess.

The first bronze image (No. 1) was found at Mainamati, Bangladesh (Plate 8.1).⁵ The goddess is seated on a long-stemmed double-petalled lotus in *ardhaparyāṅka* with her right leg pendent, displaying on her right side (in clockwise order) *varadamudrā* marked with a jewel(?), a wheel, a sword and a book, and on her left (from top to bottom) a noose, a trident, an axe, and a *vajra*.

No. 1:

pustaka | *pāśa*

khadga | *triśūla*

cakra | *paraśu*

ratna(?) + varadamudrā | *vajra*

ardhaparyāṅkāśana (*dakṣiṇapralambapāda*)

The second example (No. 2) is also from Mainamati (Plate 8.2).⁶ Seated in the same posture as the previous image, the goddess displays on her right *varadamudrā* and a *vajra*, and on her left a wheel, a noose, and a jewel(?). The remaining three attributes are indistinct.

No. 5:

khaḍga | *triśūla*
paraśu | *cakra*
ratna(?) + varadamudrā | *pustaka*
vajra | *pāśa*

sattvaparyāñkāśana on lion-throne



Plate 8.1 Image No. 1: Mahāpratisarā. Metal.
Mainamati, Bangladesh.



Plate 8.2 Image No. 2: Mahāpratisarā. Metal.
Mainamati, Bangladesh.

Summarizing the relevant iconographic data of the five Eastern Indian examples (Nos. 1-5) we notice that

- (a) the sitting posture is either *ardhaparyāṅka* (4 times), or *sattvaparyāṅka* (once);
- (b) the attributes preserved include *cakra* (5 times), *pāśa* (5 times), *varadamudrā* (5 times), *khadga* (4 times), *vajra* (4 times), *pustaka* (4 times), *triśūla* (thrice), and *paraśu* (thrice). However, with the exception of *khadga* and *pāśa* which always appear on the right or left sides, respectively, the lateral distribution of the attributes is not uniform, i.e. the remaining attributes are shown both on the right and on the left side (see App.).



Plate 8.3 Image No. 3: Mahāpratisarā. Metal. Comilla District, Bangladesh. Bangladesh National Museum, Dhaka. Inv.No.119 (after ASHER 1980: pl. 251)

II. Central Java

Let us now turn our attention to South-East Asia, specifically Central Java. Six bronze images and a large stone relief still *in situ* on a Central Javanese temple are known that show a single-headed and eight-armed goddess. They have tentatively been identified by different scholars as Tārā, Cundā, Lakṣmī, Kālī or Parvatī, and may date from the 8th to the 10th century.

The first Javanese bronze image (No. 6) is now in the Musée Guimet, Paris.¹⁴ It shows the goddess seated in *ardhaparyāṅka* on a double-petalled lotus with her right leg pendent. Her lower right hand is in *varadamudrā*; the other three right hands hold a sword, the lower part of what may have been a *vajra*, and a circular object possibly representing a wheel.¹⁵ On the left side we find a book, a lotus, the stem of which is held in the lower left hand placed on the seat, an axe, and a noose.



Plate 8.4 Image No. 4: Mahāpratisarā. Metal, found at Kurkihar, probably from south-east Bangladesh. Patna Museum, Inv.No. arch. 9752 (after SHERE 1961: no. 33)

No. 6:

<i>cakra(?)</i>		<i>pustaka</i>
<i>vajra(?)</i>		<i>padma</i>
<i>khadga</i>		<i>paraśu</i>
<i>varadamudrā</i>		<i>pāśa</i>
<i>ardhaparyāṅkāśana (dakṣiṇapralambapāda)</i>		

The second bronze image (No. 7) is now in the Leiden museum, Netherlands (Plate 8.6).¹⁶ It is perfectly preserved - in fact the best preserved image of the whole group - and all eight attributes are still extant. Seated in *sattvaparyāṅka* on a double-petalled lotus placed on a square pedestal, she holds a *vajra* in her lower right hand, followed by an axe,¹⁷ a sword, and a long staff topped by a half *vajra*. Her left hands hold a trident, a four-spoked wheel, a long staff topped by a roundish object which may represent a jewel standard, and a noose.



Plate 8.5 Image No. 5: Mahāpratisarā. Stone, probably from Kurkihar, Bihar. Metropolitan Museum, New York (after SOTHEBY'S New York, March 27, 1991: lot 40)

No. 7:

vajradaṇḍa | *triśūla*

khadga | *cakra*

paraśu | *ratnadhvaja*

vajra | *pāśa*

sattvaparyāṅkāśana

The third example (No. 8) is also in the Leiden museum (Plate 8.7).¹⁸ Seated in the same posture and on a similar socle as the previous figure, her right hands hold a *vajra*, an axe(?),¹⁹ a noose, and a sword, while on the left we see a wheel, the handle of a trident which is now broken off but was still visible on an old photograph taken in c. 1890,²⁰ a jewel in the palm of the lower left hand, and a lotus.



Plate 8.6 Image No. 7: Mahāpratisarā. Metal, Central Java. Rijksmuseum voor Volkenkunde, Leiden. Inv.No. 1630-36. Photo Courtesy Rijks Museum (after LE BONHEUR 1971: 211, ph. [3])



Plate 8.7 Image No. 8: Mahāpratisarā. Metal, Central Java. Rijksmuseum voor Volkenkunde, Leiden. Inv.No. 1630-18. Photo Courtesy Rijksmuseum Voor Volkenkunde (after LE BONHEUR 1971 : 211, ph. [4])

No. 8.

khadga | *cakra*
pāśa | *triśūla*
paraśu(?) | *ratna*
vajra | *padma*
sattvaparyāṅkāśana

The fourth bronze image (No. 9), again in the Leiden museum,²¹ is seated in *vajraparyāṅka*, not on a lotus but directly on a lion-throne. On her right she shows

varadamudrā and holds an *akṣamālā* or a noose(?), the handle of a sword, and an unidentifiable attribute. ~~On her left~~ we see what may represent a bunch of flowers, the handle of a staff, a noose or an *akṣamālā*, and the lower-most hand is placed on the lap showing *dhyānamudrā*.

No. 9:

? | bunch of flowers(?)

khaḍga | handle of staff (of *triśūla*?)

akṣamālā or pāśa(?) | *pāśa* or *akṣamālā*(?)

varadamudrā | *dhyānamudrā*

vajraparyāṅkāsa on lion-throne

The fifth bronze image (No. 10), in a Javanese private collection,²² shows the goddess seated in *vajraparyāṅka* on a lotus. Her lower right hand displays *varadamudrā* with a small round object, possibly a jewel; of the other right attributes only a sword has been preserved. On her left we notice a book, the handle of a staff, an axe, and another handle.

No. 10:

	?		<i>pustaka</i>
	<i>khaḍgā</i>		handle of staff (<i>triśūla</i> ?)
	?		<i>paraśu</i>
	<i>ratna(?) + varadamudrā</i>		handle of staff
	<i>vajraparyāṅkāśana</i>		

The sixth image (No. 11), now in an American collection,²³ is again seated in *vajraparyāṅka*. Of her attributes, only a noose(?) visible on her right knee, the handle of a sword, and a *vajra* in her right hands, as well as a fruit or a jewel(?) in her lower-most left hand are still preserved, while only stubs remain of the other attributes.

No. 11:

	<i>vajra</i>		?
	<i>khaḍga(?)</i>		handle of staff(?)
handle of staff			handle of staff(?)
	<i>pāśa(?)</i>		<i>ratna(?)</i> or fruit(?)
	<i>vajraparyāṅkāsaṇa</i>		

The seventh and last example from Java (No. 12)²⁴ is a large stone relief carved in the centre of the north-eastern wall of the Candi Mendut (Plate 8.8),²⁵ a temple in Central Java of the late 8th or early 9th century, about 3 km to the east of Borobudur. The goddess is seated in *vajraparyāṅka* on a double-petalled lotus placed on a high pedestal. In her right hands she holds a conch, a *vajra*, a wheel with four spokes, and a rosary, and on the left a book²⁶ placed on a lotus(?), an elephant hook, an axe,²⁷ and a fruit or a jewel(?).²⁸ The goddess is accompanied by two Bodhisattvas, Avalokiteśvara(?) on her right and Mañjuśrī(?) on her left. Above her large oval halo a tree is carved, elaborately decorated with birds and garlands and flanked by two flying Vidyādhara.

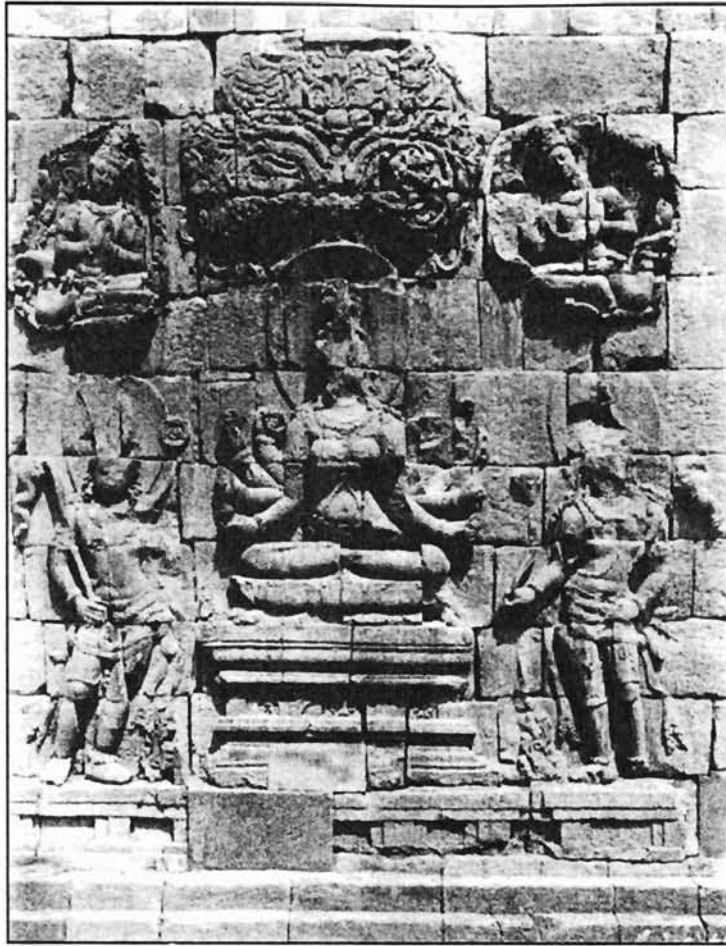


Plate 8.8 Image No. 12: Mahāpratisarā. Stone relief, Candi Mendut, Central Java. Photo courtesy Leiden University Library, OD 2015

No. 12:

akṣamālā | *pustaka* (on flower?)

cakra | *aṅkuśa*

vajra | *paraśu*

śaṅkha | *ratna*(?) or fruit(?)

vajraparyāṅkāśana

Summarizing the relevant iconographic data of the seven Javanese images (Nos. 6-12) we notice that

- (a) the sitting posture is either *vajraparyāṅka* (4 times), *sattvaparyāṅka* (twice), or *ardhaparyāṅka* (once);

- (b) the attributes preserved include *khadga* (6 times), *pāśa* (5 times), *vajra* (5 times), *paraśu* (5 times), *ratna* or *ratnadhvaja* (5 times), *cakra* (4 times), *varadamudrā* (thrice), *pustaka* (thrice), *triśūla* (twice), and *padma* (twice). The remains of the indistinct or broken attributes most often show the handle of a rather long object. Regarding the lateral distribution of the attributes, it can be noticed that *khadga*, *vajra* and *akṣamālā* generally appear on the right side and *triśūla*, *pustaka* and *ratna* / *ratnadhvaja* on the left, while the other attributes appear on both sides.

It may be pointed out that the majority of the attributes are common to most of the Eastern Indian and the Javanese examples, viz. the sword, the noose, the wheel, the *vajra*, the axe, the book, the trident, and *varadamudrā*, while the lotus, the jewel standard, the elephant hook, the rosary, and the conch are only found in some of the Javanese examples (see App.).

III. Central Asia

In order to get some hints regarding the proper identification of the single-headed and eight-armed images from Eastern India and Java, it is necessary to take into consideration some representations of a similar deity that have been found in China and in Japan. A drawing, a painting, and several woodblock prints of a 'magic prayer' (*dhāraṇī*) dedicated to the deity Mahāpratisarā are preserved in different collections. While the major portion of these *maṇḍala*s is filled with the Sanskrit text and a number of symbols, the centre is generally occupied by an eight-armed image of the deity representing the deified magic spell.

The first item, a fragmentary drawing on silk (No. 13), was found in the vicinity of Changan, the western capital of the Tang dynasty (618-907). It may date from the end of the 8th or from the 9th century.²⁹ The central figure (Plate 8.9) is seated in *vajraparyāṅka* on a double-petalled lotus. The lower-most attribute on the right is not preserved, the others being a sword, an axe and a noose. On the left we find a book, a trident, a jewel standard and a wheel placed on top of a lotus.³⁰

No. 13:	<i>pāśa</i> <i>pustaka</i>
	<i>paraśu</i> <i>triśūla</i>
	<i>khadga</i> <i>ratnadhvaja</i>
	? <i>cakra</i> on <i>padma</i>
	<i>vajraparyāṅkāśana</i>

The second item (No. 14) is a woodblock print that bears a dated inscription corresponding to 980 A.D. It was found by Sir Aurel Stein in Cave 17 at Dunhuang and is now in the British Museum.³¹ The central figure (Plate 8.10) is seated in *vajraparyāṅka* on a double-petalled lotus. The right hands hold a book, a standard, a wheel, and an indistinct object. On the left we find a *vajra*, an axe, a noose and a sword.³²



Plate 8.9 Image No. 13. Mahāpratisarādhārāṇī: Detail of central figure. Ink drawing on silk, found near Changan, China (after ZHONGGUO 1988: pl. 16b)



Plate 8.10 Image No. 14. Mahāpratisarādhārāṇī: Detail of central figure. Woodblock print on paper, dated 980 AD, found at Dunhuang, China. British Museum, London. Inv.No. OA 1919.1-1.0249 (after WHITFIELD 1983: fig. 151)



Plate 8.11 Image No. 15. Mahāpratisarādhārāṇī: Detail of central figure. Woodblock print on paper, China. Musée Guimet, Paris. Inv.No. MG.17689 (after GIËS 1996: fig. 37)



Plate 8.12 Image No. 16. Mahāpratisarādhārāṇī: Detail of central figure. Painting on silk, Japan. Ferenc Hopp Museum of Eastern Asiatic Arts, Budapest. Inv.No. 5614. Photo: Miklós Sulyok, courtesy Ferenc Hopp Museum

No. 14:

? | *vajra*
cakra | *paraśu*
dhvaja | *pāśa*
pustaka | *khaḍga*
vajraparyāṅkāśana

The third item (No. 15) is another woodblock print of the *Mahāpratisarādhāraṇi* that was found by Paul Pelliot and is now in the Musée Guimet, Paris.³³ The inner circle is similar to the previous print while the surrounding elements differ considerably, and the inscription at the bottom does not contain a date. The central figure (Plate 8.11) is seated in *vajraparyāṅka* on a lotus, holding on the right side a book, a sword, a *vajra*, and an axe, and on the left a trident, a round object possibly a wheel, a standard and a noose.³⁴

No. 15:

paraśu | *triśūla*
vajra | *cakra*(?)
khaḍga | *dhvaja*
pustaka | *pāśa*
vajraparyāṅkāśana

The fourth example (No. 16) is a c. 17th century painting from Japan, now in the Budapest Museum, Hungary (Plate 8.12).³⁵ The eight attributes are depicted in the margin of the painting, each shown in its relative position and placed on a lotus. The central image is again seated in *vajraparyāṅka* on a lotus, holding a *vajra*, a sword, an axe, and a noose on the right, and a book, a trident, a jewel standard, and a wheel placed on top of a lotus on the left.

No. 16:

pāśa | *pustaka*
paraśu | *triśūla*
khaḍga | *ratmadhvaja*
vajra | *cakra on padma*
vajraparyāṅkāśana

All these *maṇḍala*s are based on the *Mahāpratisarādhāraṇisūtra* which is not preserved in the original Sanskrit version but only exists in two Chinese translations:³⁶ one by Ratnacinta, who lived at the end of the 7th century, and another by Amoghavajra, the famous master who lived from 705 to 774 A.D.³⁷ The central deity in these *maṇḍala*s is Mahāpratisarā, who is regarded as a form of Maheśvara (i.e. Śiva) or of Avalokiteśvara. The exact status of this deity within the hierarchy of Esoteric Buddhism is rather unclear.³⁸

Depicted invariably as a male deity in Central and East Asia,³⁹ he is either referred to as a "*vidyārāja*" (i.e. "King of magic knowledge"), or as a "*bodhisattva*". His cult must have been quite popular and widespread in Central Asia at the end of the first millennium since



Plate 8.13 Image No. 17: Mahāpratisarā Bodhisattva, from *Mahākaruṇāgarbha-odbhavamaṇḍala*, Japan. Graphic representation (after SNODGRASS 1988: fig. 84)



Plate 8.14 Image No. 18: Mahāpratisarā Bodhisattva. Drawing on paper, from *Shosonzuzō*, dated 1858 AD, Japan. Collection of John & Susan Huntington (after HUNTINGTON 1975: 293)

by worshipping his *mantra* the votary could expect to be protected from all kinds of diseases, from wind and rain, from wild animals, poisonous snakes, demons and evil spirits. The *dhāraṇī* drawings may be regarded as representing the "*vidyārāja*" aspect of Mahāpratisarā.

Summarizing the iconographic data of the four representations of the "*vidyārāja*" aspect of Mahāpratisarā from Central Asia and Japan (Nos. 13-16) we notice that

- (a) the sitting posture is invariably *vajraparyāṅka*;
- (b) all images have the same eight attributes. However, the lateral distribution of these attributes, with the exception of the *trishūla*, is not uniform: the remaining seven attributes appear both on the left and on the right side (see App.). This clearly indicates that the lateral distribution of the attributes was not fixed in the iconographic prescription according to which the images were modelled.



Plate 8.15 Image No. 19: Mahāpratisarā Bodhisattva. Modern drawing, Japan (after SAWA 1962: fig. 69)



Plate 8.16 Image No. 20: Mahāpratisarā Bodhisattva. Wood, Japan. Völkerkundemuseum der Universität Zürich (Switzerland) (after STOLL 1968: Abb. 52)

IV. Japan

The *bodhisattva* aspect of Mahāpratisarā with a similar iconographic concept is depicted in the Japanese *Taizō genzu mandara*, a *mandala* modelled after the *Mahākaruṇāgarbhadbhavamāṇḍala* (also known as *Garbhamāṇḍala* or *Garbhadhātumāṇḍala*), which was brought from China to Japan by the famous master Kūkai (Kōbō daishi) in 806 A.D., and which became the authoritative drawing for the *Mahāvairocanasūtra*.⁴⁰

In the *Garbhadhātumāṇḍala*, the image of Mahāpratisarā is located in the upper-most position of the Avalokiteśvara mansion on the proper right of the central lotus dominated by Mahāvairocana.⁴¹ It belongs to a group of fourteen Bodhisattvas who are not mentioned in the *Mahāvairocanasūtra* but were later added to the previous group of seven Bodhisattvas when the *mandala* reached its final form.

The details can be seen well in graphic representations of the *mandala* such as the one drawn by Hasegawa Tōshuku in 1834.⁴² Mahāpratisarā (No. 17) (Plate 8.13)⁴³ is invariably shown seated in *vajraparyāṅka*, holding a *vajra*, a sword, an axe and a trident on the right, and a book, a jewel standard, a noose and a wheel placed on a lotus on the left.⁴⁴



Plate 8.17 Image No. 21: Mahāpratisarā Bodhisattva(?). Wood. Japan. Ferenc Hopp Museum of Eastern Asiatic Arts, Budapest, Inv.No. 56.98. Photo: Miklós Sulyok, courtesy Ferenc Hopp Museum

No. 17:

triśūla | *pustaka*
paraśu | *ratnadhvaja*
khaḍga | *pāśa*
vajra | *cakra on padma*
vajraparyāṅkāśana

Several paintings of the *Garbhadhātumaṇḍala* are preserved in Japanese Shingon temples.⁴⁵ A few examples are also found in western collections, *e.g.* a 13th-14th century painting now in the Brooklyn Museum of Art,⁴⁶ and another one of the mid-13th century, now in an American private collection.⁴⁷ They all show the deity in the same position and with an identical distribution of the attributes.

The inclusion of this form of Mahāpratisarā in Japanese model books such as the 19th century *Shosonzuzō* dated 1858 A.D. (No. 18), in the collection of John and Susan Huntington (Plate 8.14),⁴⁸ suggests an uninterrupted transmission of the iconography up



Plate 8.18 Image No. 22: Mahāpratisarā(?). Metal, Tibet. Private Collection, USA

to modern times. In this example, the axe on the right has been replaced with a staff topped by a circular knob, all the other attributes being the same as in the previous image. Significantly, a book is shown below on the left side.

No. 18:

<i>triśūla</i>		<i>pustaka</i>
<i>ratnadaṇḍa</i>		<i>dhvaja</i>
<i>khadga</i>		<i>pāśa</i>
<i>vajra</i>		<i>cakra on padma</i>
<i>vajraparyāṅkāśana</i>		

A drawing of the figure in a modern illustrated Dictionary of Buddhist Icons (No. 19) repeats the same iconography with some minor variations (Plate 8.15)⁴⁹: the noose is found on the right side, the axe is topped by a trident, and on the left is another trident.

(a) the sitting posture is invariably *vajraparyāṅka*;

(b) six of the eight attributes are common to all images, the exceptions being *pustaka* which in No. 20 has been replaced with *aṅkuśa*(?), and *paraśu* which in No. 18 has been replaced with *ratnadāṇḍa*. Regarding the lateral distribution of the attributes, it can be noticed that *vajra* and *khadga* generally appear on the right side while *cakra* and *ratna* / *ratnadhvaja* are always found on the left; *triśūla*, *pāśa* and *paraśu* are depicted either on the right or on the left.

V. Early Iconography and Cult of Mahāpratisarā

Comparing the "*vidyārāja*" (Nos. 13-16) and the "*bodhisattva*" (Nos. 17-21) images of Mahāpratisarā, it is interesting to note that six of the eight attributes are identical, the only exceptions being the two replacements in Nos. 18 and 20 just mentioned. The lateral distribution, however, is by no means uniform as can be gleaned from the list given in the Appendix: all attributes do appear on the right and on the left side, obviously indicating that there was no rule for the lateral distribution of the attributes.

Comparing the Central and East Asian images securely identified as Mahāpratisarā (Nos. 13-21) with those of the single-headed and eight-armed goddess from Eastern India and Java (Nos. 1-12), it becomes obvious that seven attributes are common to all three groups, viz. *cakra*, *triśūla*, *khadga*, *pustaka*, *pāśa*, *vajra*, and *paraśu*. Differences can be noticed with regard to the following details:

- (a) a standard (*dhvaja*) or jewel standard (*ratnadhvaja*) is present in all but one of the Chinese and Japanese examples (No. 20), but only in one image from Java (No. 7). However, three Javanese (Nos. 8, 11, 12) and one Bengal image (No. 2) show a jewel (*ratna*) as an attribute in one of the left hands, as does No. 20;
- (b) *varadamudrā* is displayed by all five Eastern Indian and by three Javanese images, but not by a single Central or East Asian image. In addition, three figures from Eastern India (Nos. 1, 4, 5) and one from Java (No. 10) have the palm of the *varada* hand marked with a jewel;
- (c) the lotus is combined with the wheel in five Chinese and Japanese images (Nos. 13, 16-19), while two examples from Java (Nos. 6, 8) and one from Japan (No. 21) show the lotus as a separate attribute. The lotus does not appear in any Eastern Indian figure;
- (d) a number of attributes is peculiar to only a few images: *aṅkuśa* is found once in Java (No. 12) and once in Japan (No. 20), *vajradanḍa* once in Java (No. 7), *ratnadāṇḍa* once in Japan (No. 18), *akṣamālā* twice in Java (Nos. 9, 12), *śaṅkha* once in Java (No. 12), and *dhyanamudrā* once in Java (No. 9). It thus appears that the Javanese images form the most heterogeneous and the Eastern Indian images the most homogeneous group;
- (e) the sitting posture is *vajraparyāṅka* in all the Chinese and Japanese (Nos. 13-21) and in four Javanese (Nos. 9-12) examples, but not in a single Eastern Indian image, where we find either *ardhaparyāṅka* or *sattvaparyāṅka*.

All these differences can be regarded as variations of minor iconographic details. However, the close resemblance of the majority of the Eastern Indian and Javanese sculptures with the securely identified and iconographically very similar Central and East Asian images does suggest that most of them, if not all,⁵³ are representations of the same deity, Mahāpratisarā.

Apparently, the images presented here document an early stage in the iconographic development of Mahāpratisarā, witnessed in the furthest corners of the Buddhist world between the 8th and the 10th century. At that stage, seven attributes seem to have been the standard accessories, namely *cakra*, *vajra*, *triśūla*, *pustaka*, *paraśu*, *pāśa*, and *khadga*, while the remaining ones, namely *padma*, *ratna*, *aṅkuśa*, *dhvaja*, and *śaṅkha*, as well as the *mudrā.s varada* and *dhyāna*, were variable.⁵⁴

If we compare this iconography with the further developed multi-headed forms of Mahāpratisarā as the leading member of the Five Protective Goddesses (Pañcarakṣā), described in the 11th/12th century Vajrayāna texts *Sādhnamālā* and *Niṣpannayogāvali*, we notice that six out of the seven standard attributes, namely *cakra*, *triśūla*, *khadga*, *vajra*, *paraśu*, and *pāśa*, have been retained from the earlier single-headed type, whereas the variable features were replaced with the bow-and-arrow pair, the ubiquitous attribute of the multi-headed type.⁵⁵ With regard to the sitting posture, the Vajrayāna sources — as well as the later images of which hundreds are known from India, Nepal, Tibet and China — mirror the variability and inconsistency of the earlier type, since we do find images of Mahāpratisarā seated in *vajra*°, *sattva*°, and *ardhaparyāṅkāśana*.

Geographically, the countries from which the images originate mark the boundaries of the Buddhist world, with Eastern India as the central hub from which the rapidly developing concepts of the Buddhist doctrines radiated. The interconnecting link between the peripheral countries and the Eastern Indian centre can be seen in the extensive travel activities of the Buddhist monks during that time. It is well known that Indonesia was visited by a number of Tantric Buddhist masters in the 8th century, among them Amoghavajra, the translator of the *Mahāpratisarādhāraṇi*, who played a key role in the spread of Tantric Buddhism in China. Amoghavajra's visit to Java in 718 is a documented fact, and it is also known that he received instruction in the *Garbhadhātumaṇḍala* when he visited Sri Lanka on his journey to South Asia between 741 and 746.⁵⁶ It is particularly interesting to note that during this journey, which brought him again to Java, he repeatedly recited the *Mahāpratisarādhāraṇi* to ward off terrible storms and protect the ship from sea monsters.⁵⁷ The two regions where the cult of Mahāpratisarā was apparently popular in the 8th through the 10th century, namely the centre of the Tang empire in China (Dunhuang and Changan), and Central Java,⁵⁸ are thus linked by the activities of Amoghavajra.

Regarding the five Eastern Indian images, it is interesting to note that four of them (Nos. 1-4) originate from south-east Bengal suggesting that the region around Mainamati was especially related to the worship of the goddess, and perhaps also Kurkihar in Bihar, where one of the bronzes has been found (No. 4), and which is probably also the place of provenance of the only stone sculpture (No. 5). Although no inscriptional evidence has yet been discovered to substantiate the influence of Bengal art on Java, the stylistic similarities between the bronzes from south-east Bengal and Java indicate that "the most obvious source for Javanese metal images ... is the eastern Bengal region, ... which developed its own distinctive characteristics at an early date."⁵⁹ That the eastern Bengal region played an

important role in the interactions between the Pāla world and Indonesia is also evident from the fact that several of the bronzes that were found in Java originate from the Comilla and Chittagong Districts.⁶⁰ Furthermore, it has been stated that "in addition to the unmistakable stylistic and technical debt of Javanese metal images to Pāla works, there is a strong iconographic association. Interestingly, the Javanese idiom appears to be the only Pāla-dependent tradition that did not emphasize Śākyamuni Buddha, ... [but] rather emphasized the forms of Buddhism ... in which ... other Mahāyāna and Tantric divinities predominated."⁶¹ All this may explain the presence of Mahāpratisarā images both in Java and in south-east Bengal.

VI. Tibet

Finally, an early 15th century gilded bronze from Tibet (No. 22) shall be considered (Plate 8.18).⁶² As in the Eastern Indian bronzes, the goddess is seated in *ardhaparyāṅka*, but here her left leg is pendent. Only four of her eight attributes are preserved: on the right we find a sword and a noose, and on the left a trident and a wheel. Noteworthy features of this figure are the fierce facial expression, the prominent stomach, the skull-crown, and the snake-necklace.

No. 22:

? | ?

? | *triśūla*

pāśa | ?

khadga | *cakra*

ardhaparyāṅkāśana (*vāmapralambapāda*)

Although the four attributes preserved belong to the standard accessories of Mahāpratisarā, and the stubs of the two broken attributes on her left side could be interpreted as the remains of an axe and a jewel standard, her prominent stomach as well as the snake-necklace are features not met with in any image of the goddess so far.

The style of the figure may point to Densatil in Central Tibet as a possible place of origin. A number of iconographically extremely interesting bronzes have been tentatively attributed to the monastery at Densatil, among them several Rakṣā figures,⁶³ for example an image of Mahāpratisarā,⁶⁴ closely modelled according to the later iconography of the *Sādhanamālā* (SM 194-196). Some images of uncertain identity may be added to this list,⁶⁵ for example an unidentified goddess (No. 23)⁶⁶ who shares the peculiar features with the first image, although the bow and the arrow point to the later type.

No. 23:

khadga | ?

? | *cāpa*

padma | ?

pāśa | ?

ardhaparyāṅkāśana (*vāmapralambapāda*)

Both figures could be regarded as documenting a late revival in the Tibetan pantheon of the early single-headed type of Mahāpratisarā, drawing back on the iconography of the *Mahāpartisarādhāraṇī* and mixing it with that of the *Sāadhanamālā*. If this tentative identification is correct, the Tibetan bronzes would add another facette to the pan-Asian extension of the cult of the single-faced and eight-armed Mahāpratisarā that was witnessed in Eastern India, Central Java, and Central Asia five hundred years before.

Notes and References

1. See MALLMANN 1975: 290-291; MEVISSSEN 1989: 362-363.
2. See e.g. the Pañcarakṣā ms. dated in the 14th year of Nayapāla, now in the Cambridge University Library, No. Add. 1688 (publ.: *Oriental Art*, II, 4 (1950), pl. opp. p. 133, top; SARASWATI 1977: col.pl. 245; *idem* 1978: col.pl. on p. 44; D.C. BHATTACHARYYA 1978: pl. 30, top); Pañcarakṣā ms. dated in the 39th year of Rāmapāla, now in the Benkaim Collection, Los Angeles (publ.: BLACK 1967: fig. 3a, misidentified as Mahāśītavatī); Aṣṭasāhasrikā-Prajñāpāramitā manuscript dated in the 4th year of Gopāla (III), now in the Museum of Fine Arts, Boston (publ.: LOSTY 1989: fig. 12, not identified); Pañcarakṣā ms. dated Śaka 1211 = 1289 A.D., now in the Asiatic Society, Calcutta, No. G.4078 (publ.: D.C. BHATTACHARYYA 1978: pl. 35; PAL/MEECH-PEKARIK 1988: fig. 30; in both publications, the image is misidentified as Mahāmāyūrī).
3. Bangladesh National Museum (BNM), Dhaka, Inv.No. 81; height 76.2 cm; found in Vikramapura, Munshiganj, Dhaka district. Publ.: B. BHATTACHARYYA 1924: pl. XXXV.b; *idem* 1958: fig. 185; BHATTASALI 1929: pl. XXIV; BANERJI 1933: pl. XLI(a); KIRFEL 1948: Taf. 20, Abb. 58; DAS GUPTA 1975: Abb. 2; D.C. BHATTACHARYYA 1978: pl. 27; MEVISSSEN 1991/92: pl. III-34.
4. Another sculpture of the 10th century in the BNM (Inv.No. 66.40; height 137 cm; found at Bhavanipur, Munshiganj, Dhaka dist.) has been tentatively identified by some scholars as Mahāpratisarā (e.g. B. BHATTACHARYYA 1924: pl. XXXV.c; *idem* 1958: fig. 184 (each time reproduced without the pedestal); BANERJI 1933: pl. XLI(b); MALLMANN 1975: 295; HUNTINGTON 1984: fig. 206), while others have regarded the figure to represent Bhṛkuṭī (e.g. BHATTASALI 1929: pl. XIX; CHATTERJI 1930: pl. opp. p. 20; MUKHOPADHYAY 1985: fig. 36; SHAMSUL ALAM 1985: fig. 69; SINGH 1993: pl. V, 4). In a recent study, C. BAUTZE-PICRON (forthc.: fig. 21) conclusively attributes the sculpture to an atelier in Bihar (Nalanda/Ghosrajan/Tetravan region) and identifies it as Mārīci.
5. Mainamati Museum; from Śālban Vihāra, Mainamati; c. 8th century; height 18.2 cm. Publ.: RAY/KHANDALAVALA/GORAKSHKAR 1986: no. 37 "Chunḍā"; Husain 1997: Fig. on p. 195.. "Bodhisakti Tārā"; cf. MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 368 "Mahāpratisarā".
6. Mainamati Museum; c. 9th century. The published photograph of the image is very bad, and a better photo does not seem to be available because the figure has been stolen. Publ.: SHAMSUL ALAM 1982: pl. IX.d "Mahapratissara"; cf. MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 375, note 207 "Mahāpratisarā".
7. Inv.No. I.B.(IV)a/1; c. 8th/9th century; height 51cm. Published and identified as "Chandī": BANERJI 1924-25: 156, pl. XL(e); *idem* 1933: 138, pl. LXVIII(b); as "Sītāpatrā": BHATTASALI 1929: 53-54, pl. XVIII; MAJUMDAR 1971: pl. LXIII, fig. 152; ASHER 1980: 99, 123, pl. 251;

- HUNTINGTON 1984: 189-190, fig. 254; SHAMSUL ALAM 1985: 77, fig. 15; RAY/KHANDALAVALA/GORAKSHKAR 1986: no. 42; SENGUPTA 1989/90: 126, fig. 4; cf. MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 375, note 207 "Mahāpratisarā".
8. The indistinct right-hand attribute is identified by BHATTASALI (1929: 54) as "The Bow (? lost)"; also by RAY/KHANDALAVALA/GORAKSHKAR (1986: no. 42) as "*chāpa*".
 9. According to BHATTASALI (1929: 54) "The Thunder-bolt".
 10. One of the indistinct left-hand attributes is identified by BHATTASALI (1929: 54) as "The Arrow". RAY/KHANDALAVALA/GORAKSHKAR (1986: no. 42) remark that "the lower left hand rests on the seat and in her remaining [left] hands she holds a *kheṭaka* (now lost?), *śara* and *vajra*".
 11. Inv.No. arch. 9752; c. 9th century; height 38 cm. Publ.: SHERE 1961: no. 33 "Devī, eight armed Tārā ?"; RAY/KHANDALAVALA/GORAKSHKAR 1986: no. 265 "Sitātapatrā"; JHA 1993: 128 "Mahāpratisarā", pl. XLV.A "Mahāpratyaṅgirā" (sic); MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 368, 382, pl. VII-58 "Mahāpratisarā".
 12. According to Claudine Bautze-Picron, Berlin; personal communication.
 13. C. 2nd half of 9th century; height 57.8 cm. Publ.: Sotheby's New York, March 27, 1991: lot 40 "Durga"; MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 367-368, 375, note 205, 382, pl. VII-57 "Mahāpratisarā".
 14. Inv.No. 3624; c. 10th century; height 18 cm. Publ.: KROM 1917: 394, fig. 19 "Tjoenda"; LE BONHEUR 1971: 204-208, phs. on pp. 205, 207 "Cundā?"; cf. SINGHAL 1991: 388, 395, No. 11 "Cundā"; MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 375, note 212 "Mahāpratisarā?".
 15. LE BONHEUR 1971: 204: "*akṣamālā*"; SINGHAL 1991: 388, 395, No. 11 "rosary".
 16. Rijksmuseum voor Volkenkunde, Inv.No. 1630-36. Publ.: WITH 1920: pl. 137 "Tārā?"; BOSCH 1926: 73, pl. 7; LE BONHEUR 1971: 208-211, ph. [3] "Cundā?"; MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 368, 383, pl. VII-59 "Mahāpratisarā"; cf. SINGHAL 1991: 390, 395, No. 14 "Cundā".
 17. LE BONHEUR 1971: 209: "*aṅkuśa*"; SINGHAL 1991: 390, 395, No. 14 "goad (*aṅkuśa*)".
 18. Rijksmuseum voor Volkenkunde, Inv.No. 1630-18; silver image on bronze socle. Publ.: Catalogus 1909 : 108, pl. XIV, Fig. 1 : BOSCH 1926: 70, pl. 5; VAN LOHMEISEN-~~IN~~ LEEN¹²⁹ 1966: 130 ¹³⁰ note 1, ¹³¹ *Chundā*; LE BONHEUR 1971: 208-211, ph. [4] "Cundā?"; cf. SINGHAL 1991: 390, 395, No. 15 "Cundā"; MEVISSSEN 1991/92: 368 "Mahāpratisarā". There also exists a smaller replica of the image completely in bronze (cf. LE BONHEUR 1971: 210, referring to BOSCH 1926: 73, pl. 7). -DE
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 19. LE BONHEUR 1971: 209: "*aṅkuśa*?"; SINGHAL 1991: 390, 395, No. 15 "goad (*aṅkuśa*)".
 20. See BOSCH 1926: 70, pl. 5.
 21. Rijksmuseum voor Volkenkunde, Inv.No. 1403-2842: "Kālī or Pārvatī". Publ.: LE BONHEUR 1971: 208-211, ph. [1] "Cundā?"; cf. SINGHAL 1991: 388, 395, No. 12 "Cundā".
 22. Surabaja, Collection Roëner: "Tārā". Publ.: LE BONHEUR 1971: 208-211, ph. [2] "Cundā?"; cf. SINGHAL 1991: 390, 395, No. 13 "Cundā".
 23. New York, The Asia Society, Mr. and Mrs. John D. Rockefeller 3rd Collection, Inv.No. 1979.84; copper alloy; c. 8th century; height c. 16 cm. Publ.: HUNTINGTON/HUNTINGTON 1990: 228, b/w.ill. 70.

24. I am grateful to Marijke Klokke, Leiden, for drawing my attention to this image and supplying a photograph and valuable references.
25. Publ.: MOENS 1921: 580-581, foto 2 "Çuddhawidyā-cakti (Ekajaṭi?)"; cf. KERSJES/DEN HAMER 1903: 17; FERGUSSON 1910, II: 429 "Lakshmī"; KROM 1918: 425-427 "Tāra? Cundā?"; GETTY 1928: 129 "Cundā" (erroneously mentioned as standing); LE BONHEUR 1971: 210, note 20; BERNET KEMPERS 1976: 224 "Either Tara, or Cunda, or some other deity"; SINGHAL 1985: 712-713 "Cundā"; *idem* 1991: 388, 395, No. 10 "Cundā"; LOKESH CHANDRA 1995: 35 "Cundā".
26. KROM 1918: 425; MOENS 1921: 580; BERNET KEMPERS 1976: 224; SINGHAL 1985: 712; *idem* 1991: 388, 395, No. 10.
27. LE BONHEUR 1971: 210, note 20 "ṭarika".
28. According to KERSJES/DEN HAMER (1903: 17) the attribute is "mogelijk een plant" (possibly a plant); according to SINGHAL (1985: 712; *idem* 1991: 388, 395, No. 10) it is a "bijapūra".
29. Ink on silk; 26.5 x 26.5 cm. Publ.: LI/GUAN 1984: 50-52; *Zhongguo* 1988: 10, 34-35, pls. 16a, 16b; EICHENBAUM KARETZKY 1994: fig. 14.
30. According to EICHENBAUM KARETZKY 1994: 84, note 26, "A very similar mandala was unearthed in Chengdu in 1944; it is now in the Sichuan Provincial Museum."
31. Inv.No. OA 1919.1-1.0249 (Ch. xliii. 004); ink on paper; 41.7 x 30.3 cm (height of central image c. 4.6 cm). The date corresponds to 24 July 980 A.D. (according to Raphael Petrucci in STEIN 1921, III: 1399, the date ~~as~~ corresponds to "8 août 980"). Publ.: STEIN 1921, II: 893-894, 1044-1045, III: 1399, IV: pl. CII; MATSUMOTO 1937: 604-609, pl. 157b; WHITFIELD 1983: fig. 151; WHITFIELD/FARRER 1990: 106-107, no. 87; SØRENSEN 1991/92: 296-298, 328, 341, fig. 6 (his description is most comprehensive and includes a translation of the inscription at the bottom). □ Another print from the same woodblock was found by Paul Pelliot and is now in the Musée Guimet, Paris (Inv.No. EO.3639). It is slightly damaged at the bottom. See GIÈS 1996: fig. 36. -- For manuscript illustrations depicting this form of Mahāpratisarā, see MATSUMOTO 1937: 595-615, pls. 157ab, 158-160 (cited after SØRENSEN 1991/92: 328 note 48). - On pp. 295, 296, 328 notes 49 and 55, SØRENSEN refers to aniconic line drawings of Mahāpratisarā-*maṇḍala*s, in which the central figure and often also the surrounding deities and ritual implements are indicated by Sanskrit letters. For such aniconic *bijamaṇḍala*s, see e.g. MATSUMOTO: figs. on pp. 270, 271 - ~~med~~ / 1935 *Idem* 1937: pl. 161b; TAJIMA 1959: pl. 3; HUNTINGTON 1975: 294; RAMBACH 1979: 63.
32. Although the inscription enumerates eight attributes of the deity, the image seems to have a fifth pair of hands held in front of the chest. STEIN (1921, II: 1044) remarks that there is an "extra emblem on L. side as if for ninth arm, evidently mistake".
33. Inv.No. MG.17689; ink on paper; 43.4 x 32.0 cm; 10th century. Publ.: GIÈS 1996: fig. 37.
34. In another blockprint of the *Mahāpratisarādhāraṇi* in the Musée Guimet (Inv.No. MG. 17688; ink on paper; 37.0 x 29.7 cm; 10th century), the central figure is depicted as a two-armed Buddha displaying *dharmacakramudrā*. See GIÈS 1996: fig. 39.
35. Ferenc Hopp Museum of Eastern Asiatic Arts, Inv.No. 5614; colour and gold on silk; H.: 42.5 cm, W.: 40.5 cm. Publ.: FERENCZY 1987: 41, fig. 21 "Dhāraṇi ... dominated by a figure of Vajrapāṇi" (*sic*); CSEH 1996: col.pl. on p. 56 "Daizuigu-darani (Mahapratissara)".

36. For references see CHOU 1945: 322, App. N; Sørensen 1991/92: 295, 328, notes 50-52.
37. For the biography of Amoghavajra, see CHOU 1945: 284-307; TAJIMA 1959: 26-27; YAMASAKI 1988: 19-20.
38. Sørensen 1991/92: 295; SNODGRASS 1988: 305-306.
39. A similar change of sex from a female (Indian) *vidyārājñi* to a male (Chinese) *vidyārāja* can also be observed in the case of Mahāmāyūri / K'ung-ch'iao ming-wang (Jap. Kujaku-myōō); cf. MEVISSEN 1990: 229f. Compare also Avalokiteśvara / Kuan-yin (Jap. Kannon).
40. On the *Garbhadhātumaṇḍala*, see TAJIMA 1959: 53-141; MINORU 1978: 83-93; LOKESH CHANDRA 1986; SNODGRASS 1988: 183-186; MAMMITZSCH 1991.
41. See TAJIMA 1959: 87-91; SNODGRASS 1988: 284-286; MAMMITZSCH 1991: 214ff.
42. See TAJIMA 1959: ix, pl. 1; = LOKESH CHANDRA 1972; = RAMBACH 1979: 103.
43. LOKESH CHANDRA 1971: no. 33, fig. 44; = SNODGRASS 1988: 305, fig. 84; = MAMMITZSCH 1991: 216, no. 30; = MEVISSEN 1991/92: 366-367, fig. 55.
44. This lateral distribution of the attributes exactly follows the one described in Taishō, *Zuzō* (Iconographic Supplement), vol. I, p. 12^{c21}; cf. TAJIMA 1959: 298.
45. See TAJIMA 1959: viii-ix; ISHIMOTO 1978; MINORU 1978: pl. 1; RAMBACH 1979: col.pls. on pp. 45, 48; ISHIDA 1987: pls. 3, 6, 8; Art Bouddhique Japonais 1989: 99, no. 20, col.pl. on p. 69.
46. Inv. No. 21.240.2, Kamakura Period, 13th-14th century. Publ.: LEIDY/THURMAN 1997: 116, no.41.
47. Cambridge (Mass.), Private Collection, Kamakura period, mid-13th century. Publ.: LEIDY/THURMAN 1997: 118-119, no. 43.
48. Publ.: HUNTINGTON 1975: 293 "Mahāpratisarā bodhisattva (Jap. Daizuita bosatsu)".
49. Publ.: SAWA 1962: 95, fig. 69; MEVISSEN 1991/92: 366-367, fig. 56.
50. Völkerkundemuseum der Universität Zürich, height 110 cm. Publ.: STOLL 1968: Abb. 52 (on p. 106 erroneously referred to as Abb. 51).
51. Ferenc Hopp Museum of Eastern Asiatic Arts, Inv.No. 56.98; height: 40.2 cm. Publ.: *Japanese Art* 1994: 280, No. 32 "Sarasvatī"; *Catalogue of Japanese Art* 1995: 210, No. 1077; CSEH 1996: col.pl. on p. 65 "Home shrine of Benzaiten (S.: Sarasvatī)".
52. Presently the image is only seven-armed. According to Béla Kelényi and Éva Cseh, Ferenc Hopp Museum, Budapest (personal communication), the second and third arms on the left are broken, and a new arm has been restored and fixed in between the former two arms.
53. The most problematic image is No. 9, since the upper left hand is holding what appears to be a bunch of flowers, while the lower left is in *dhyānamudrā*, both rather atypical features. However, also the stone sculpture from the Candi Mendut (No. 12) seems to have a flower in the same position (supporting a book), and the wood sculpture from Japan (No. 20) has the lower left hand in *dhyānamudrā* (supporting a wheel). On the other hand, the remaining attributes of No. 9 do not include any of the typical *āyudha*s of Mahāpratisarā such as a wheel, a book, or a trident. Thus, image No. 9 cannot unequivocally be identified as Mahāpratisarā.

54. An even earlier stage in the iconographic development is found in a *sādhana* by Candragomin (c. 7th century), where the goddess is described as single-headed and two-armed. For references and representations, see ALLINGER 1997: 667-669; MEVISSEN 1991/92: 365-367, 381, figs. 53-54, pl. VI-52.
55. See MEVISSEN 1991/92: 358ff. From the table in MEVISSEN 1989: 362-365 it can be gleaned that also *śaṅkha* and *dhvaja* were retained in one of the further developed types of Mahāpratisarā (SM 201). Some of the variable attributes were transferred to other Rakṣā goddesses: *pustaka*, *aṅkuśa* and *akṣasūtra* became the attributes of the early form of her younger co-Rakṣā Mahāśītavatī (SM 200); *varadamudrā* became a standard feature of all her four co-Rakṣās, especially of her elder co-Rakṣā Mahāmāyūrī; *padma* finally re-emerged as an ancillary attribute of her three younger co-Rakṣās Mahāsahasrapramardanī, Mahāmantrānusārīnī and Mahāśītavatī (SM 206 and NSP 18).
56. CHOU 1945: 284-307, 321-322, esp. 290-291; YAMASAKI 1988: 19.
57. Cf. CHOU 1945: 290: "When they reached Kalinga (note 29: This country is identified as Java. The name is probably due to an early colonization in Java of immigrants from Kalinga in East India. ...) they met with a heavy storm. Each merchant, being terrified, tried to propitiate [the gods] by the method of his own country, but without result ... Amoghavajra said: 'I have a plan. Don't worry.' Thereupon, with a five-fingered vajra of Bodhicitta in his right hand and the *Prajñāpāramitāsūtra* in his left hand, he recited the *Mahāpratisarādhāraṇī* and performed the rite ... The wind subsided immediately and the sea became calm and clear. Later they came across a large whale ... It was even more threatening than the previous calamity and the merchants were ready to give up their lives. Amoghavajra performed the rites as before ... At once all the dangers disappeared."
58. Some scholars have stated that the iconographic lay-out of the Candi Mendut in Central Java, where the large stone relief of Mahāpratisarā (No. 12) is still extant, was modelled after the *Garbhadhātumaṇḍala* (cf. MOENS 1921; SINGHAL 1985; LOKESH CHANDRA 1995). However, there is only partial agreement, and the existing correspondences - in my opinion - do not permit one to regard the structure as being a faithful and complete application of that complicated concept. On the other hand, the presence of Mahāpratisarā does point to the prevalence of tantric concepts in Java at the beginning of the 9th century.
59. HUNTINGTON/HUNTINGTON 1990: 209.
60. Cf. LUNSINGH SCHEURLEER/KLOKKE 1988: 27-30.
61. HUNTINGTON/HUNTINGTON 1990: 209-210.
62. Private Collection, USA; height 28.8 cm.
63. E.g. ROSSI and ROSSI 1994: 49, no. 22; = SOTHEBY'S New York, November 30, 1994: lot 70.
64. KOLLER, 18./19. November 1994: 3, Taf. 3, Nr. 33; = SPINK 1995: 26, no. 17.
65. E.g. *Oriental Art*, XXI, 3 (1975): 215 (advertisement Doris Wiener); LO BUE 1994: no. 76; SOTHEBY'S New York, March 21/22, 1990: lot 313; UHLIG 1995: 162-163, no. 107 (= SOTHEBY'S New York, October 5, 1990: lot 77; = VON SCHROEDER 1981: 432, no. 114D; = PAL 1969: 96, 148, no. 59).
66. SOTHEBY'S New York, March 28, 1996: lot 48.

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APPENDIX : List of single-headed and eight-armed images

Position of attributes (R = Right; L = Left)

Image No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	
Region	Eastern India					Central Java							China			Japan						Tibet		
Attribute	Date	8th-10th century					8th-10th century							8th-10th c.			13th-20th century						15th c.	
cakra cakra on padma padma	R	L	R	R	L	?R	L	L				R	L	R	?L					L		L		
triśūla	L			R	L		L	L					L		L	L	R	R	L	L	L	L		
khṛdga	R		R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R	?R		R	L	R	R	R	R	R	R		R	R	
pustaka	R		?L	L	L	L				L		L	L	R	R	L	L	L	L					
pāśa	L	L	L	L	L	L	L	R	?L		?R		R	L	L	R	L	L	R	?R	R	R	R	
vajra	L	R		L	R	?R	R	R			R	R		L	R	R	R	R	R	R				
paraśu	L			L	R	L	R	?R		L		L	R	L	R	R	R		R	L	R			
varadamudrā varada + ratna	R	R	R			R			R															
(ratna)dhvaja ratna		?L					L				?L	?L	L	R	L	L	L	L	L		R			
aṅkuśa												L								?R				
vajradanḍa							R																	
ratnadanḍa																		R						
akṣamālā									?R			R												
dhyānamudrā									L															
śaṅkha												R												
cāpa																							L	
indistinct		3	3						3	4	4		1	1							3	4	5	
vajraparyāṅka									X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X			
ardhaparyāṅka	X	X	X	X		X																X	X	
sattvaparyāṅka					X		X	X																

/a

/c

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NOTES BY THE EDITOR :

- Due to unavoidable reasons, the original spellings and styles of notes and references of different authors have been retained unaltered.
- Articles bearing asterisk (*) in the titles are selections from those presented in the Third International Congress on Bengal Art held at Rajshahi, Bogra and Dhaka on February 16-20, 1999.